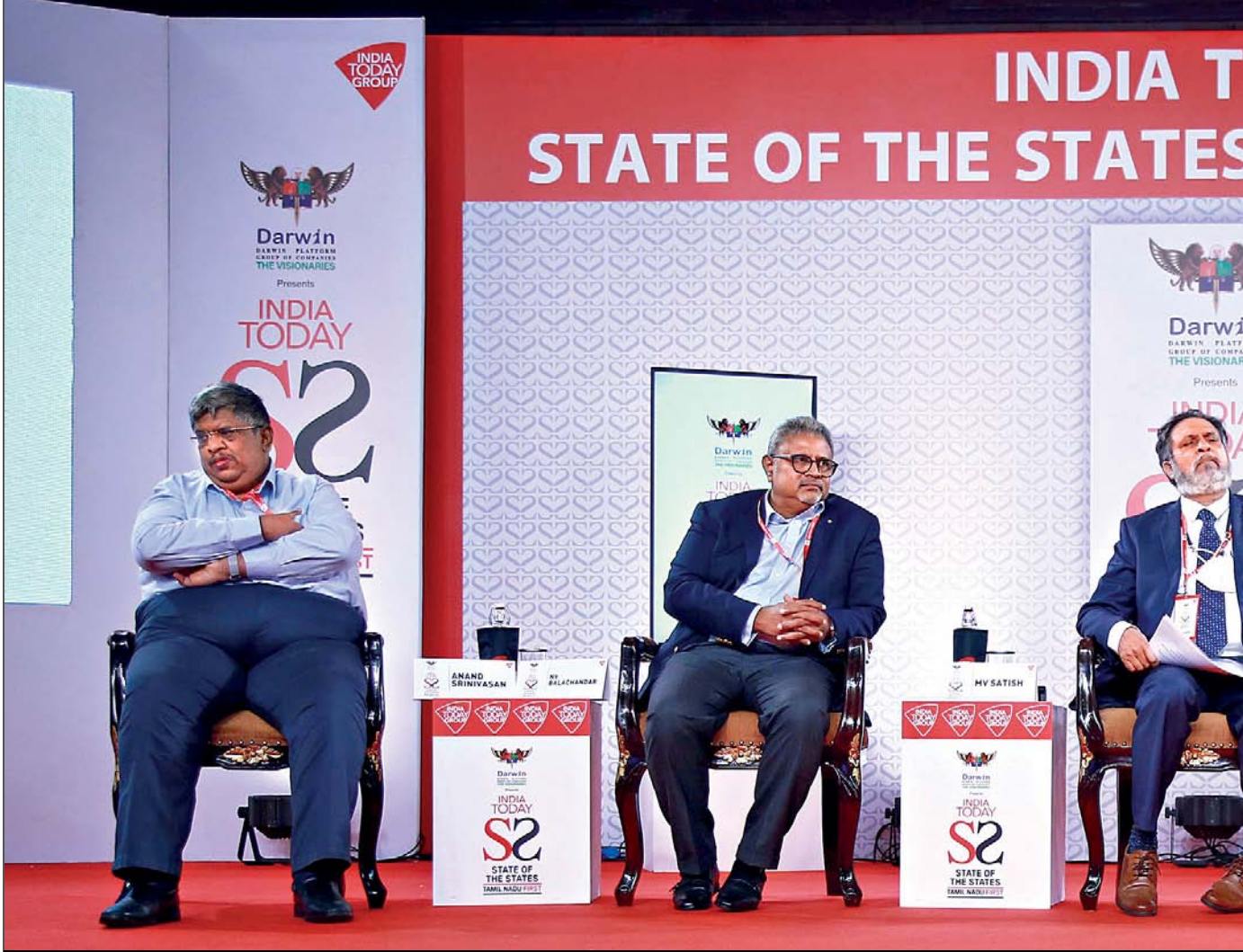


(from left) **Anand Srinivasan,** *Economist, Chennai;* **N.V. Balachandar,** *Chief Sustainability Officer and President-Communication, CSR & Corporate Affairs, Ashok Leyland;* **M.V. Satish,** *Whole-Time Director & Sr. Executive Vice-President (Buildings), Larsen & Toubro;* **S. Krishnan,** *IAS, Additional Chief Secretary, Industries, Government of Tamil Nadu*

INDIA TODAY SS STATE OF THE STATES TAMIL NADU FIRST

The Southern Powerhouse

As Tamil Nadu goes from strength to strength, experts debate how it can become India's leading state

By Amarnath K. Menon

Launched in 2003, the India Today's annual State of the States (SOS) survey has, over the years, not only become the most respected barometer of how different states in India are performing across vital development indices, but also come to serve as a report card of the nation. The states are ranked judging by their performance in several categories, like economy, infrastructure, industry, agriculture, health, education, law and order and governance.

For four years in a row now Tamil Nadu has emerged as the